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What is it?

A career in animation and game development means you become the person who constructs the characters and environments and then go on to make these two elements interact with each other. The computer-generated environment or the visual elements is what these two areas share in common. Their difference is that animated entertainment is a passive medium, while games are interactive. This adds one more element to gaming, which is programming.

Philip Edward Alexy, professor at *Picasso Animation* says, “The gaming industry has evolved over the last few years from simple bitmap pixelated scrollers and mindless killing-spree first-person shooters, to involving cinematic narratives where the players becomes one of, if not the only, major characters of that narrative. No longer is the majority of system resources being used to simply run the gaming engine. Now the actual artistic content can be as close to photorealism as one would see on television.”

Why is it needed?

The outsourcing industry has attracted plenty of animation and game studios to send work over to India. There is some fantastic work being churned out at the numerous studios around India.

The gaming industry is a relatively new entrant in India. This is largely because the video gaming phenomenon is relatively new to India. Therefore, there is a serious lack of game production professionals who are gamers themselves. This lack of exposure is a major weak point. This is, therefore, the first USP that you have, as a gamer, over most of the game production professionals in India.

Animation requires a familiarity with the English language. This gives India the advantage for more outsourced work. Most animation studios in India are creating skilled manpower for the animation market through various training programmes. Besides this, we also have a large pool of low-cost, high-quality software engineers. A number of Indian animation companies have set up hi-tech studios manned by such engineers.

A US-based animator can cost about \$125 an hour. However, an Indian animator costs \$25 an hour. *Toonz Animation* offers animation at 25 per cent to 40 per cent lower rates than other Asian studios and much lower than those of American studios. The total cost for making a full-length animated film in America is estimated to be \$100 million to \$175 million. In India, it can be made for \$15 million to \$25 million. All these factors point to the fact that the animation-outsourced industry is set to grow.

Rajesh Rao, founder of *Dhruva Interactive*, India's first development gaming studio addresses the gaming scenario. According to Rao, “With the often quoted statistics of 350 million young Indians between the age of 15 and 35, there is definitely huge potential. I mean, China has a 3.5 billion dollar industry and it just happened in the last 8-9 years. In India too, things are bound to improve, especially with such disposable incomes. It'll be among the top 3-4. People who join now, have an early day entry. They will have experience. By the time the demand grows, the market increases, they will